

SKILLS, LIVELIHOODS & ENTREPRENEURSHIP

Building Skills. Creating Livelihoods. Enabling Self-Reliance.

Overview

Skills are a foundation for economic opportunity. However, in many rural and underserved communities, people may have the willingness to work but lack access to practical skills, livelihood opportunities, market exposure, financial knowledge and entrepreneurial support. Young people, women and economically vulnerable households may face:

- Limited access to practical and market-relevant skills
- Unemployment and underemployment
- Dependence on seasonal or low-income work
- Limited opportunities for self-employment
- Lack of access to entrepreneurship guidance
- Limited knowledge of markets, finance and business development
- Migration caused by inadequate local livelihood opportunities
- Difficulty converting skills into sustainable income

ISLAH believes that **skill development should not end with training**.

The real objective is to create a pathway from **learning to earning**—helping individuals acquire useful skills, identify livelihood opportunities, access markets and, where appropriate, develop their own enterprises.

Through its Skills, Livelihoods & Entrepreneurship initiatives, ISLAH seeks to strengthen the economic capabilities of individuals and communities and promote **dignified, sustainable and locally relevant livelihood opportunities**.

Our Objective

To equip rural and underserved communities with **practical skills, livelihood opportunities and entrepreneurial capabilities** that can improve employability, income generation, self-reliance and long-term economic resilience.

Our Approach

01 — Skills Development

Promoting practical, market-relevant and livelihood-oriented skills based on local needs and emerging opportunities.

02 — Employability & Job Readiness

Helping individuals develop the technical, digital, communication and workplace capabilities required to pursue employment opportunities.

03 — Livelihood Development

Connecting skills with practical income-generating opportunities, including self-employment, local enterprises and other appropriate livelihood pathways.

04 — Entrepreneurship

Encouraging individuals with suitable skills and potential to explore entrepreneurship, micro-enterprises and small-business opportunities.

Key Initiatives

ISLAH aims to develop initiatives such as:

01-Skills & Employability Programme

Practical training designed to improve job readiness, employability and income-generating capabilities.

02-Livelihood Development Initiative

Supporting individuals and households in identifying and developing suitable livelihood pathways.

03-Rural Entrepreneurship Initiative

Encouraging rural entrepreneurship through business awareness, mentoring and enterprise-development support.

04-Micro-Enterprise & Self-Employment Support

Helping suitable participants explore small-scale businesses and self-employment opportunities.

Learn → Develop Skills → Earn → Start Enterprise → Grow

Who We Seek to Support

Our initiatives may give particular attention to:

- Rural youth
- Women and girls
- Economically weaker households
- Unemployed and underemployed individuals
- Aspiring entrepreneurs
- Small-scale producers and service providers
- Individuals seeking alternative livelihood opportunities

Expected Impact

Through these initiatives, ISLAH aims to contribute towards:

- Increased access to practical and market-relevant skills
- Improved employability and job readiness
- Greater self-employment and income-generation opportunities
- Increased economic participation of women and youth
- Growth of rural entrepreneurship and micro-enterprises
- Improved financial and digital capability
- Stronger connections between skills and livelihood opportunities
- Reduced dependence on unsustainable or low-income livelihoods
- Greater local economic participation
- Increased self-confidence, dignity and self-reliance
- More resilient households and communities

From Skills to Self-Reliance

Our approach can be presented through a simple pathway:

LEARN

Skills • Knowledge • Capability



PREPARE

Employability • Digital Skills • Financial Awareness



WORK

Employment • Self-Employment • Livelihoods



CREATE

Entrepreneurship • Enterprise • Innovation



EARN

Income • Economic Participation • Stability



GROW

Self-Reliance • Resilience • Dignity

Our Vision

ISLAH envisions rural and underserved communities where people have the **skills, knowledge, opportunities and confidence to build sustainable livelihoods and shape their own economic future.**

We believe that meaningful economic empowerment begins when people are not simply provided with assistance but are given the **capability and opportunity to create sustainable solutions for themselves and their communities.**

“Building skills that create livelihoods—enabling people to earn with dignity, grow with confidence and build sustainable futures.”

ISLAH

Skills & Employability Programme

Building Skills. Creating Opportunity. Enabling Sustainable Livelihoods.

The **Skills & Employability Programme** is an ISLAH initiative designed to equip young people and economically vulnerable communities in rural and underserved areas with **practical, relevant and employment-oriented skills.**

Education can open the door to opportunity, but employability also depends on practical capabilities, confidence, communication, digital awareness and the ability to adapt to changing workplace requirements. ISLAH seeks to bridge the gap between **learning and livelihood** by helping participants develop skills that can be applied in employment, self-employment and everyday economic life.

Our Objective

The programme aims to help individuals move from **potential to preparedness**—developing the practical and professional capabilities needed to pursue meaningful work and build sustainable livelihood pathways.

Our focus is not limited to training alone. We seek to connect **skills with employability, opportunity and self-reliance.**

Our Approach

1. Market-Relevant Skills

Promoting practical skills based on local opportunities, participant interests and evolving employment needs.

2. Employability Skills

Developing communication, teamwork, problem-solving, workplace behaviour, time management and professional confidence.

3. Digital Capability

Building basic digital and computer skills that can support education, employment, entrepreneurship and access to opportunities.

4. Job Readiness

Supporting participants with CV preparation, interview skills, workplace awareness and practical preparation for employment.

5. Career Awareness

Helping participants understand different employment, training and livelihood pathways and the capabilities required for them.

6. Entrepreneurship & Self-Employment

Introducing self-employment and entrepreneurship as alternative livelihood pathways for individuals with appropriate skills, interests and aspirations.

7. Opportunity & Market Linkages

Where feasible, facilitating connections with employers, businesses, training institutions, entrepreneurs and relevant opportunity networks.

Implementation Approach

Depending on local needs and available resources, the programme may include:

- Digital and computer skills
- Office and administrative skills
- Retail and service-sector skills
- Tailoring and garment-related skills
- Beauty and wellness services
- Handicrafts and small-scale production
- Food processing and related activities
- Basic entrepreneurship and business skills
- Communication and workplace skills
- Other locally relevant vocational and livelihood skills

Who We Aim to Support

The programme may focus on:

- Rural and underserved youth
- School and college graduates
- First-time job seekers
- Unemployed and underemployed individuals
- Women seeking livelihood opportunities
- Economically vulnerable households
- Individuals interested in self-employment and entrepreneurship

Expected Impact

ISLAH aims to contribute towards:

- Improved practical and employment-oriented skills
- Greater workplace readiness and confidence
- Improved digital and professional capabilities
- Better awareness of career and livelihood opportunities
- Increased readiness for employment and self-employment
- Greater entrepreneurial awareness
- Stronger connections with relevant opportunity networks
- Progress towards sustainable livelihoods and self-reliance

The ISLAH Employability Pathway

LEARN → DEVELOP → PREPARE → CONNECT → WORK → GROW

We believe that meaningful skill development should lead beyond the classroom. The goal is to help people **apply what they learn, access opportunity and build a sustainable livelihood.**

Our Vision

To create pathways through which rural and underserved communities can acquire **relevant skills, develop confidence and access opportunities for dignified work, entrepreneurship and sustainable livelihoods.**

“Skills create capability. Employability creates opportunity. Opportunity creates a pathway to self-reliance.”

ISLAH

Livelihood Development Initiative

Creating Livelihoods. Strengthening Families. Building Self-Reliance.

The **Livelihood Development Initiative** is an ISLAH programme focused on helping individuals and families in rural and underserved communities develop sustainable and dignified sources of income.

For many communities, the challenge is not simply the absence of work, but limited access to **skills, productive opportunities, resources, markets, financial knowledge and support networks.** ISLAH seeks to address these interconnected barriers by supporting practical livelihood pathways that build upon local skills, resources and economic opportunities.

Our Objective

The initiative aims to help people move from vulnerability towards greater economic resilience by strengthening their ability to **develop, access and sustain livelihood opportunities.**

Our approach connects skills and resources with practical economic activity—whether through employment, self-employment, home-based work, small enterprises or locally relevant livelihood activities.

Our Approach

1. Livelihood Assessment & Opportunity Identification

Understanding local skills, resources, interests and market opportunities to identify realistic livelihood pathways.

2. Skills for Livelihoods

Connecting individuals with relevant practical skills and training that can support employment, self-employment or income-generating activities.

3. Self-Employment & Home-Based Livelihoods

Encouraging suitable home-based and small-scale livelihood activities that can enable individuals, particularly women, to participate in economic life.

4. Micro-Enterprise Development

Supporting aspiring livelihood participants in understanding basic enterprise planning, costing, pricing, record keeping and customer management.

5. Financial & Digital Capability

Promoting financial literacy, savings awareness, responsible money management and digital capabilities relevant to livelihood development.

6. Market & Business Linkages

Where feasible, connecting producers, service providers and emerging entrepreneurs with local markets, customers, businesses and other relevant networks.

7. Mentorship & Continued Support

Providing guidance and mentorship, where feasible, to help participants overcome initial challenges and strengthen the sustainability of their livelihood activities.

Implementation Approach

Depending on local needs and feasibility, the initiative may support:

- Agriculture and allied livelihood activities
- Tailoring and garment-related work
- Handicrafts and traditional products
- Food processing and home-based production
- Retail and local services
- Digital and technology-enabled services
- Small-scale production
- Micro-enterprises and self-employment
- Other locally relevant livelihood opportunities

Who We Aim to Support

The initiative may focus on:

- Rural and underserved households
- Women and youth seeking livelihood opportunities
- Unemployed and underemployed individuals
- Small-scale producers and service providers
- Members of Self-Help Groups
- Aspiring micro-entrepreneurs

- Economically vulnerable families

Expected Impact

ISLAH aims to contribute towards:

- Increased access to livelihood opportunities
- Improved income-generation capabilities
- Greater readiness for self-employment
- Strengthened small-scale livelihood activities
- Increased financial and digital awareness
- Improved access to markets and support networks
- Greater participation of women and youth in local economies
- Increased economic resilience and self-reliance

The ISLAH Livelihood Pathway

IDENTIFY → LEARN → DEVELOP → START → EARN → SUSTAIN → GROW

We believe sustainable livelihoods are built through more than income alone. They require **capability, opportunity, confidence, resilience and continued access to appropriate support.**

Our Vision

To create pathways through which rural and underserved communities can build **secure, dignified and sustainable livelihoods**, enabling individuals and families to become more economically resilient and self-reliant.

“A sustainable livelihood is more than a source of income—it is a pathway to dignity, resilience and a better future.”

ISLAH

Rural Entrepreneurship Initiative

Local Ideas. Local Enterprise. Sustainable Rural Growth.

Overview

The **Rural Entrepreneurship Initiative** is an ISLAH programme designed to encourage and support entrepreneurship within rural and underserved communities by helping individuals transform **local skills, resources, ideas and opportunities into sustainable enterprises**. Rural communities possess significant entrepreneurial potential—from agriculture and traditional crafts to local services, food processing and emerging digital opportunities. However, limited access to business knowledge, finance, markets, technology, mentorship and enterprise networks can prevent promising ideas from developing into viable businesses.

ISLAH seeks to help bridge these gaps by creating a supportive pathway from **entrepreneurial awareness to enterprise development, income generation and sustainable growth.**

Our Objective

The initiative aims to promote a culture of rural entrepreneurship where individuals can identify opportunities, develop practical business capabilities, start suitable enterprises and progressively build sustainable livelihoods.

Our focus is on **practical, locally relevant and inclusive entrepreneurship**, particularly for people who have limited access to conventional business support.

Our Approach

1. Entrepreneurship Awareness

Creating awareness about entrepreneurship, self-employment and local business opportunities as pathways towards income and economic independence.

2. Opportunity & Idea Identification

Helping participants identify viable business ideas based on local resources, skills, community needs and market demand.

3. Business Skills & Capacity Building

Developing practical knowledge in business planning, costing, pricing, bookkeeping, customer management, marketing and basic financial management.

4. Enterprise Start-up Support

Where feasible, providing guidance to aspiring entrepreneurs as they move from an idea towards establishing a small or micro-enterprise.

5. Digital & Financial Capability

Promoting awareness of digital tools, online opportunities, banking, digital payments and responsible financial practices relevant to enterprise development.

6. Market & Business Linkages

Where feasible, connecting rural entrepreneurs with local markets, customers, businesses, institutions, producer groups and other relevant networks.

7. Mentorship & Enterprise Growth

Providing access, where possible, to experienced entrepreneurs and professionals who can offer practical guidance on managing challenges and strengthening business sustainability.

Implementation Approach

Depending on local resources, skills and market opportunities, the initiative may support:

- Agriculture and allied enterprises
- Food processing and value-added products
- Handicrafts and traditional products
- Tailoring and garment enterprises
- Rural retail and service businesses
- Repair and technical services
- Digital and technology-enabled services
- Home-based enterprises
- Small-scale manufacturing and production
- Local tourism and community-based services
- Other locally relevant micro-enterprises

Who We Aim to Support

The initiative may focus on:

- Rural youth and aspiring entrepreneurs
- Women entrepreneurs
- Members of Self-Help Groups
- Small-scale producers and service providers
- Farmers and rural households exploring value addition
- Unemployed and underemployed individuals
- Existing micro-enterprises seeking to strengthen their businesses
- Economically vulnerable communities

Expected Impact

ISLAH aims to contribute towards:

- Greater awareness of rural entrepreneurship opportunities
- Improved business and enterprise management capabilities
- Increased readiness for self-employment
- Development of new and emerging micro-enterprises
- Strengthening of existing small businesses
- Greater financial and digital capability
- Improved access to markets and business networks
- Increased local income-generation opportunities
- Greater economic resilience and self-reliance

The ISLAH Entrepreneurship Pathway

IDENTIFY → LEARN → PLAN → START → MANAGE → CONNECT → GROW

The objective is not simply to encourage people to start businesses, but to help them develop the **knowledge, capabilities, networks and confidence required to build sustainable enterprises.**

Our Vision

To foster a vibrant rural entrepreneurship ecosystem where **local talent, skills and resources can become sustainable enterprises, meaningful livelihoods and engines of community-level economic development.**

“Entrepreneurship begins with an idea, grows through capability and creates lasting value when opportunity meets action.”

Micro-Enterprise & Self-Employment Support

Small Enterprise. Sustainable Income. Greater Independence.

The **Micro-Enterprise & Self-Employment Support Initiative** is an ISLAH programme designed to help individuals and families in rural and underserved communities explore, establish and strengthen small-scale enterprises and self-employment opportunities. For many people, formal employment may not be readily accessible. Small businesses, home-based activities, local services and micro-enterprises can provide practical pathways towards income generation and economic independence. However, turning an idea or skill into a sustainable livelihood often requires **business knowledge, planning, financial awareness, market access and continued guidance**. ISLAH seeks to help bridge these gaps through practical capacity building, mentorship and appropriate opportunity linkages.

Our Objective

The initiative aims to support individuals who wish to **start a small enterprise, strengthen an existing activity or develop self-employment as a livelihood pathway**. Our approach focuses on helping people move from **skills and ideas to viable economic activity and sustainable income**.

Our Approach

1. Enterprise & Self-Employment Awareness

Creating awareness about micro-enterprises, home-based businesses, local services and self-employment opportunities.

2. Business Idea Development

Helping participants identify feasible business ideas based on their skills, interests, local resources, community needs and market opportunities.

3. Start-up Readiness

Building practical knowledge around basic business planning, initial investment requirements, costing, pricing and operational planning.

4. Business Management Skills

Developing capabilities in record keeping, cash-flow awareness, customer management, purchasing, inventory and day-to-day business operations.

5. Financial & Digital Capability

Promoting financial literacy, responsible money management, banking awareness, digital payments and appropriate digital tools for business.

6. Market & Customer Linkages

Where feasible, helping entrepreneurs understand local markets and connect with customers, businesses, producer groups and relevant networks.

7. Mentorship & Enterprise Strengthening

Providing guidance, where feasible, to help emerging entrepreneurs address challenges, improve their practices and build more sustainable enterprises.

Implementation Approach

Depending on local needs and feasibility, support may include:

- Home-based enterprises
- Tailoring and garment work
- Handicrafts and traditional products
- Food processing and small-scale production
- Retail and local services

- Repair and technical services
- Beauty and wellness services
- Digital and technology-enabled services
- Agriculture and allied enterprises
- Other locally relevant micro-enterprises

Who We Aim to Support

The initiative may focus on:

- Rural women and youth
- Unemployed and underemployed individuals
- Aspiring micro-entrepreneurs
- Existing small-scale entrepreneurs
- Members of Self-Help Groups
- Skilled individuals seeking self-employment
- Economically vulnerable households

Expected Impact

ISLAH aims to contribute towards:

- Increased awareness of self-employment opportunities
- Improved enterprise readiness and business capabilities
- Greater access to livelihood pathways
- Development and strengthening of micro-enterprises
- Improved financial and digital capability
- Better understanding of markets and customers
- Increased income-generation opportunities
- Greater economic resilience and self-reliance

The ISLAH Enterprise Pathway

SKILL → IDEA → PLAN → START → MANAGE → EARN → GROW

The objective is not simply to encourage people to start small businesses, but to help them develop the **capability, confidence and practical knowledge needed to sustain and gradually strengthen their livelihood activities.**

Our Vision

To enable individuals in rural and underserved communities to turn **skills, ideas and local opportunities into sustainable micro-enterprises and dignified self-employment**, contributing to stronger livelihoods and greater economic independence.

“A small enterprise can create more than income—it can create confidence, dignity and a pathway towards self-reliance.”

ISLAH